

CANVA GRAPHIC DESIGN

FULL VISUAL STUDY MANUAL

Graphic Design Workflow

Strong design begins before opening the editor

Brief

Define purpose and audience

Message

Choose the main idea

Layout

Build visual hierarchy

Create

Use suitable elements

Review

Check clarity and consistency

Export

Choose the right format

Course Code	EDA-CGD-116
Level	Beginner to Intermediate
Duration	6 Weeks (19 Lessons)
Certificate	Professional Certificate in Canva Graphic Design
Prerequisite	Digital Literacy
Learning Format	Classroom + Guided Design Practicals + Final Visual Campaign

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Course Introduction

Canva Graphic Design teaches visual communication through practical design work. Learners study briefs, hierarchy, layout, typography, colour, imagery, elements, templates, social graphics, flyers, brand consistency, presentations, motion, export formats, accessibility and quality control.

Learning Objectives

- Translate a communication brief into a visual design.
- Navigate the Canva workspace confidently.
- Apply hierarchy, alignment, proximity, balance and whitespace.
- Use typography and colour consistently.
- Work responsibly with images, elements and templates.
- Create social media graphics, flyers and multi-page designs.
- Develop a simple brand system.
- Export suitable files for digital or print-oriented use.
- Review designs for accuracy, readability and accessibility.

Course Structure

1. Lesson 1: Introduction to Graphic Design and Canva
2. Lesson 2: Getting Started with the Canva Workspace
3. Lesson 3: Design Briefs, Audience and Purpose
4. Lesson 4: Visual Hierarchy
5. Lesson 5: Layout, Alignment, Proximity and Whitespace
6. Lesson 6: Typography Fundamentals
7. Lesson 7: Colour Theory and Contrast
8. Lesson 8: Shapes, Lines, Icons and Elements
9. Lesson 9: Working with Images and Uploads
10. Lesson 10: Layers, Positioning and Grouping
11. Lesson 11: Templates and Responsible Customisation
12. Lesson 12: Designing Social Media Posts
13. Lesson 13: Designing Flyers and Posters
14. Lesson 14: Brand Identity in Canva
15. Lesson 15: Presentations and Multi-Page Designs
16. Lesson 16: Simple Video, Animation and Motion Design
17. Lesson 17: Exporting, File Formats and Quality
18. Lesson 18: Design Review, Accessibility and Quality Control
19. Lesson 19: Final Canva Graphic Design Project

Lesson 1: Introduction to Graphic Design and Canva

Introduction

Graphic design is visual communication: arranging text, colour, images, shapes and space so an audience can understand a message. Canva is a browser- and app-based design platform that helps users create many common visual materials.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of introduction to graphic design and canva.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for introduction to graphic design and canva.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: A design should solve a communication problem, not merely look attractive.

Key point: Every design needs a purpose, audience and main message.

Key point: Canva provides templates, text tools, elements, uploads, pages and export options.

Key point: Templates are starting points; professional work still requires judgement, editing and consistency.

Key point: Originality, accessibility and responsible use of licensed content matter.

Graphic Design Workflow

Strong design begins before opening the editor

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Export

Choose the right format

Figure 1: Original instructional visual for Introduction to Graphic Design and Canva.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Write a brief for an Ethan Digital Academy course announcement.
2. State the audience, goal and one main message.
3. Choose a suitable design type such as social post or flyer.
4. Sketch a simple layout on paper before using Canva.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Digital Academy can use a clear design brief before producing course adverts, certificates, social posts or event materials.

Review Questions

20. What is the main purpose of introduction to graphic design and canva?
21. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
22. What common design mistake should be avoided?
23. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 1 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 2: Getting Started with the Canva Workspace

Introduction

The Canva editor combines a central canvas with panels for templates, elements, uploads and other tools.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of getting started with the canva workspace.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for getting started with the canva workspace.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: The canvas shows the design being edited.

Key point: Side panels provide content such as templates, elements and uploads.

Key point: A contextual toolbar changes according to the selected object.

Key point: Pages allow multi-page designs such as presentations or carousels.

Key point: Undo, duplicate and page-management controls support safe editing.

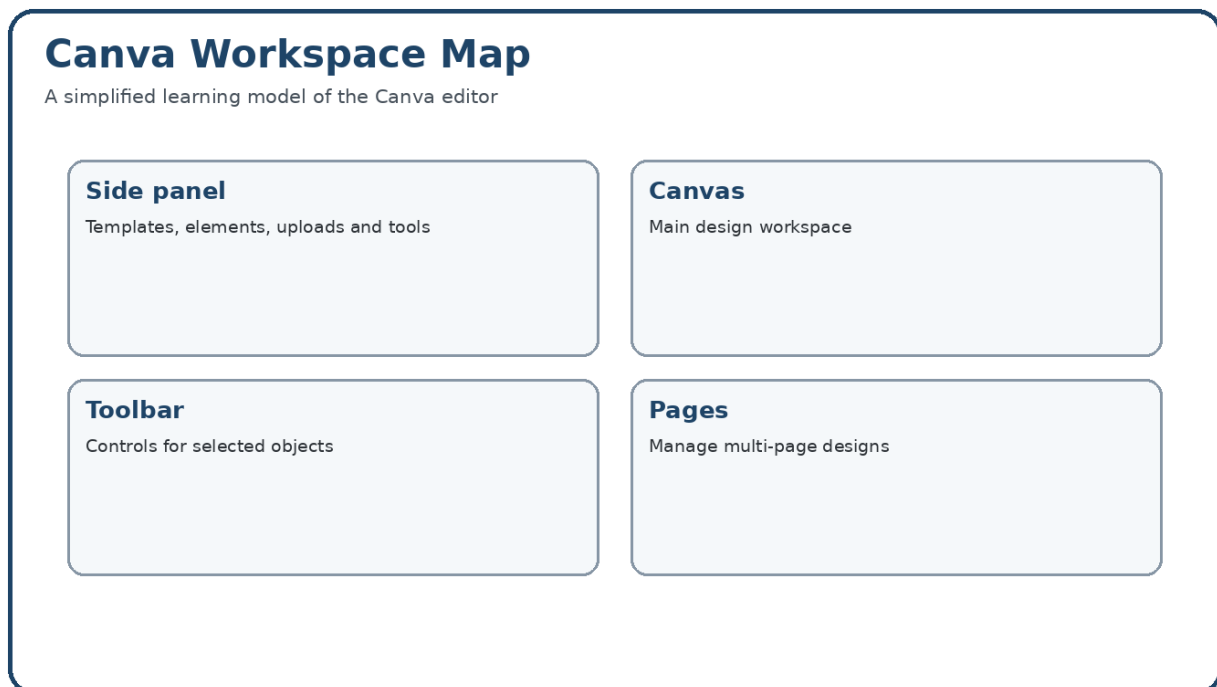


Figure 2: Original instructional visual for Getting Started with the Canva Workspace.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Open Canva using an authorised account.
2. Create a blank practice design.
3. Identify the canvas, side panel and top/context toolbar.
4. Add a second page and then delete the disposable second page.
5. Save the design with a meaningful name.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Learners should understand the workspace before relying on templates so they can edit deliberately.

Review Questions

24. What is the main purpose of getting started with the canva workspace?
25. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
26. What common design mistake should be avoided?
27. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 2 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 3: Design Briefs, Audience and Purpose

Introduction

A design brief defines what must be communicated, to whom, in what format and with what desired response.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of design briefs, audience and purpose.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for design briefs, audience and purpose.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: Purpose may be to inform, promote, teach, invite or guide.

Key point: Audience affects language, image choice, size and tone.

Key point: A single design should usually have one dominant message.

Key point: Required information should be separated from optional details.

Key point: Output destination affects dimensions and file type.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a brief for a fictional 'Digital Skills Open Day'.
2. Define primary audience.
3. Write one headline and one supporting message.
4. List essential information only.
5. Choose a final output destination.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

An Academy flyer for prospective students should prioritise programme benefit, date, venue/contact and a clear next step.

Review Questions

28. What is the main purpose of design briefs, audience and purpose?
29. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
30. What common design mistake should be avoided?
31. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 3 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 4: Visual Hierarchy

Introduction

Visual hierarchy controls the order in which viewers notice and read information.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of visual hierarchy.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for visual hierarchy.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: Size, weight, colour, contrast and position can signal importance.

Key point: The headline should usually dominate supporting details.

Key point: Too many equally strong elements create competition.

Key point: A call to action should be easy to find.

Key point: Hierarchy should remain clear on a small phone screen.

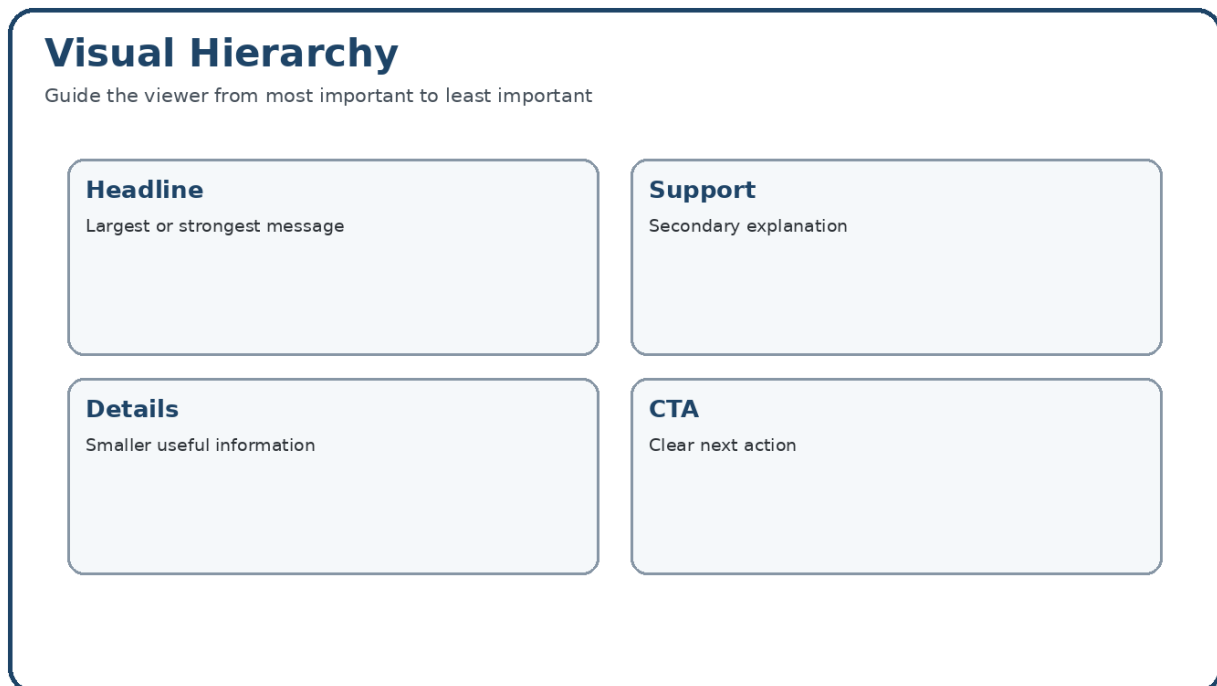


Figure 4: Original instructional visual for Visual Hierarchy.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a page with headline, subheading, body and CTA.
2. Make all text the same size and observe the weakness.
3. Adjust size and weight to create hierarchy.
4. Zoom out or preview on a small screen.
5. Refine until the reading order is obvious.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan course promotions can lead with the course name, then benefit, then schedule, then registration action.

Review Questions

32. What is the main purpose of visual hierarchy?
33. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
34. What common design mistake should be avoided?
35. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 4 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 5: Layout, Alignment, Proximity and Whitespace

Introduction

Layout principles organise elements into a clean visual system.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of layout, alignment, proximity and whitespace.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for layout, alignment, proximity and whitespace.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: Alignment creates invisible lines that connect elements.

Key point: Proximity groups related information.

Key point: Balance distributes visual weight across the page.

Key point: Whitespace separates sections and improves readability.

Key point: Crowding every empty area usually weakens a design.

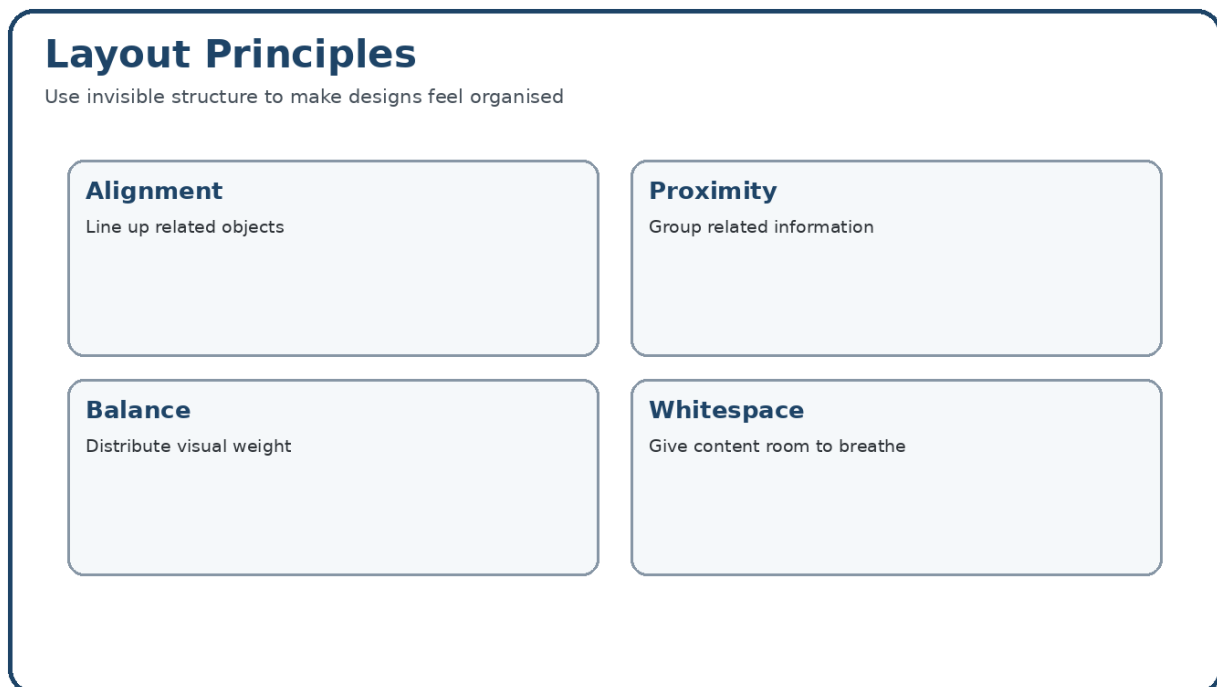


Figure 5: Original instructional visual for Layout, Alignment, Proximity and Whitespace.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create three text blocks and one image.
2. Align related items to a common edge.
3. Group date and venue information closely.
4. Increase spacing between unrelated sections.
5. Compare before and after.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy graphics should avoid the crowded 'everything in one box' look by using deliberate spacing and grouping.

Review Questions

36. What is the main purpose of layout, alignment, proximity and whitespace?
37. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
38. What common design mistake should be avoided?
39. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 5 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 6: Typography Fundamentals

Introduction

Typography is the selection and arrangement of type for readability, hierarchy and tone.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of typography fundamentals.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for typography fundamentals.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: Use a small, consistent font system rather than many unrelated fonts.

Key point: Body text must remain readable at the intended output size.

Key point: Weight, size and spacing can create hierarchy.

Key point: All caps can work for short emphasis but is harder to read in long text.

Key point: Decorative fonts should be used sparingly.

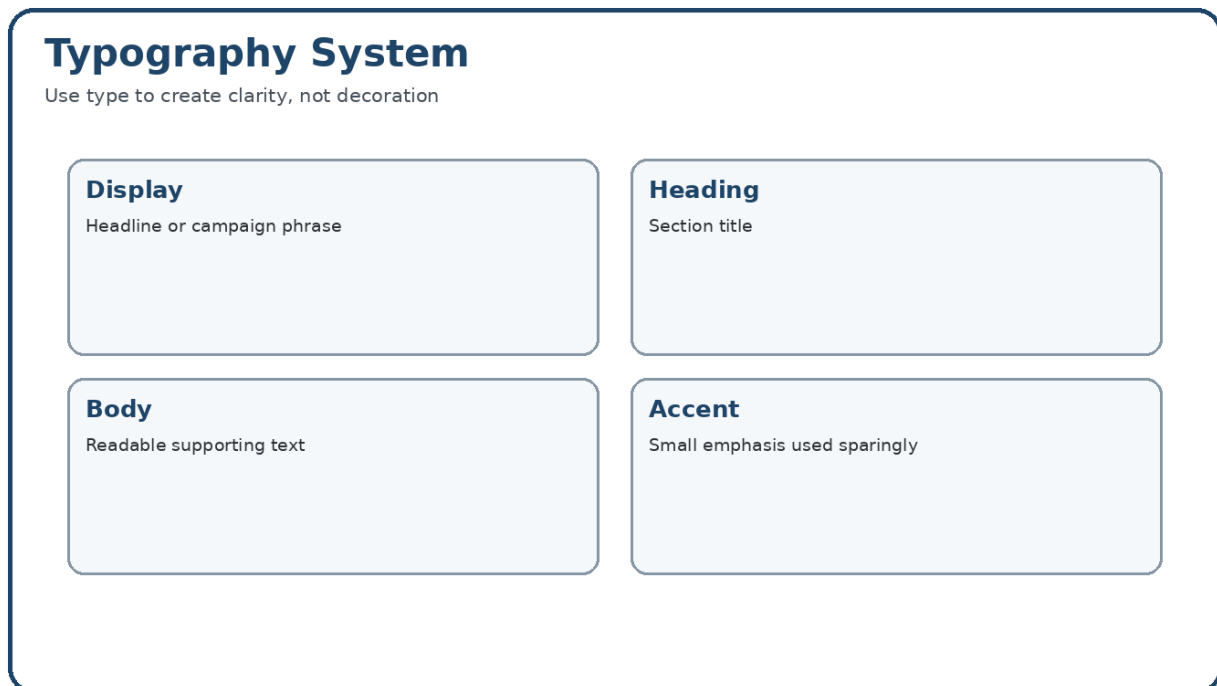


Figure 6: Original instructional visual for Typography Fundamentals.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Choose one headline font and one body font available in Canva.
2. Create headline, heading and body styles.
3. Test the body text at normal viewing size.
4. Reduce unnecessary font variations.
5. Record your type choices.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Digital Academy can use a consistent type system across course flyers and social content.

Review Questions

40. What is the main purpose of typography fundamentals?
41. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
42. What common design mistake should be avoided?
43. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 6 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 7: Colour Theory and Contrast

Introduction

Colour can create identity, mood and emphasis, but readability depends on sufficient contrast.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of colour theory and contrast.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for colour theory and contrast.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: A palette usually includes primary, secondary and accent colours.

Key point: Contrast helps important information stand out.

Key point: Text must remain readable against its background.

Key point: Too many strong colours can reduce focus.

Key point: Brand colours should be applied consistently.



Figure 7: Original instructional visual for Colour Theory and Contrast.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Choose a three-colour practice palette.
2. Create one light-background and one dark-background version.
3. Check whether headline and body text remain readable.
4. Use the accent colour only for emphasis.
5. Document the palette.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy designs can use a restrained corporate palette while reserving accent colour for calls to action.

Review Questions

44. What is the main purpose of colour theory and contrast?
45. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
46. What common design mistake should be avoided?
47. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 7 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 8: Shapes, Lines, Icons and Elements

Introduction

Graphic elements can organise information, support meaning and create visual interest.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of shapes, lines, icons and elements.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for shapes, lines, icons and elements.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: Shapes can create containers, labels and backgrounds.

Key point: Lines can divide sections or guide the eye.

Key point: Icons should be simple, relevant and stylistically consistent.

Key point: Elements should support the message rather than fill empty space.

Key point: Check licence and usage conditions for third-party assets.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Add a rectangle behind a short label.
2. Use one line to separate two sections.
3. Add two relevant icons with consistent style.
4. Remove one decorative element that adds no meaning.
5. Compare clarity.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

An Academy timetable graphic can use simple icons for time, location and learning mode without becoming decorative clutter.

Review Questions

48. What is the main purpose of shapes, lines, icons and elements?
49. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
50. What common design mistake should be avoided?
51. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 8 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 9: Working with Images and Uploads

Introduction

Images should be relevant, clear, properly cropped and legally usable.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of working with images and uploads.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for working with images and uploads.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: High-quality images reproduce better than low-resolution images.

Key point: Cropping changes focus and composition.

Key point: Frames can create consistent image shapes.

Key point: Background removal and image effects should be used purposefully where available.

Key point: Use original, authorised or properly licensed images.

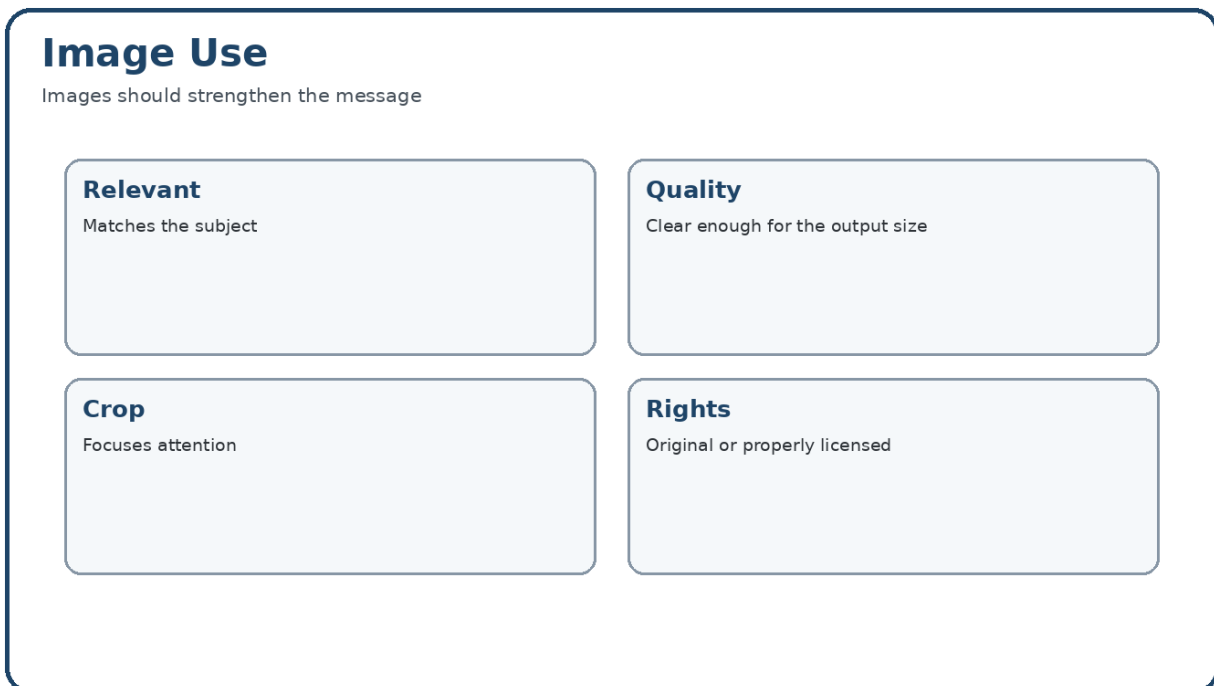


Figure 9: Original instructional visual for Working with Images and Uploads.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Upload an original or authorised practice image.
2. Place it in a frame.
3. Crop to improve focus.
4. Adjust position without distorting the subject.
5. Add a short caption.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Digital Academy can use its own training photographs and approved brand assets rather than copying random images from the web.

Review Questions

52. What is the main purpose of working with images and uploads?
53. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
54. What common design mistake should be avoided?
55. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 9 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 10: Layers, Positioning and Grouping

Introduction

Designs often contain overlapping objects that must be ordered and moved efficiently.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of layers, positioning and grouping.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for layers, positioning and grouping.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: Forward/backward controls change stacking order.

Key point: Grouping lets related elements move together.

Key point: Locking can prevent accidental movement where the feature is available.

Key point: Consistent spacing improves professional appearance.

Key point: Duplicate repeated structures rather than rebuilding them inconsistently.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a background shape, image and text.
2. Change their stacking order.
3. Group a label and icon.
4. Duplicate the group.
5. Align the duplicates evenly.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Repeated course-feature blocks can be grouped and duplicated to maintain consistency.

Review Questions

56. What is the main purpose of layers, positioning and grouping?
57. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
58. What common design mistake should be avoided?
59. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 10 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 11: Templates and Responsible Customisation

Introduction

Templates can speed up design but should be adapted to the actual brief and brand.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of templates and responsible customisation.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for templates and responsible customisation.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: A template is a structure, not a finished identity.

Key point: Replace irrelevant text, colours, images and decorative elements.

Key point: Do not force content into a template that does not suit the message.

Key point: Check that licensed template elements are permitted for the intended use.

Key point: Avoid producing near-identical copies when originality is expected.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Choose a suitable Canva template.
2. Replace all placeholder text.
3. Apply your practice palette and fonts.
4. Remove unnecessary elements.
5. Compare the result with the original template and explain your changes.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy staff can use templates for efficiency while still producing recognisably Ethan-branded work.

Review Questions

60. What is the main purpose of templates and responsible customisation?
61. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
62. What common design mistake should be avoided?
63. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 11 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 12: Designing Social Media Posts

Introduction

Social media graphics must communicate quickly, especially on mobile screens.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of designing social media posts.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for designing social media posts.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: Use one strong hook or headline.

Key point: Keep supporting text concise.

Key point: Maintain brand recognition through repeated visual choices.

Key point: Design dimensions should match the intended platform placement.

Key point: A call to action should be specific when the post needs a response.

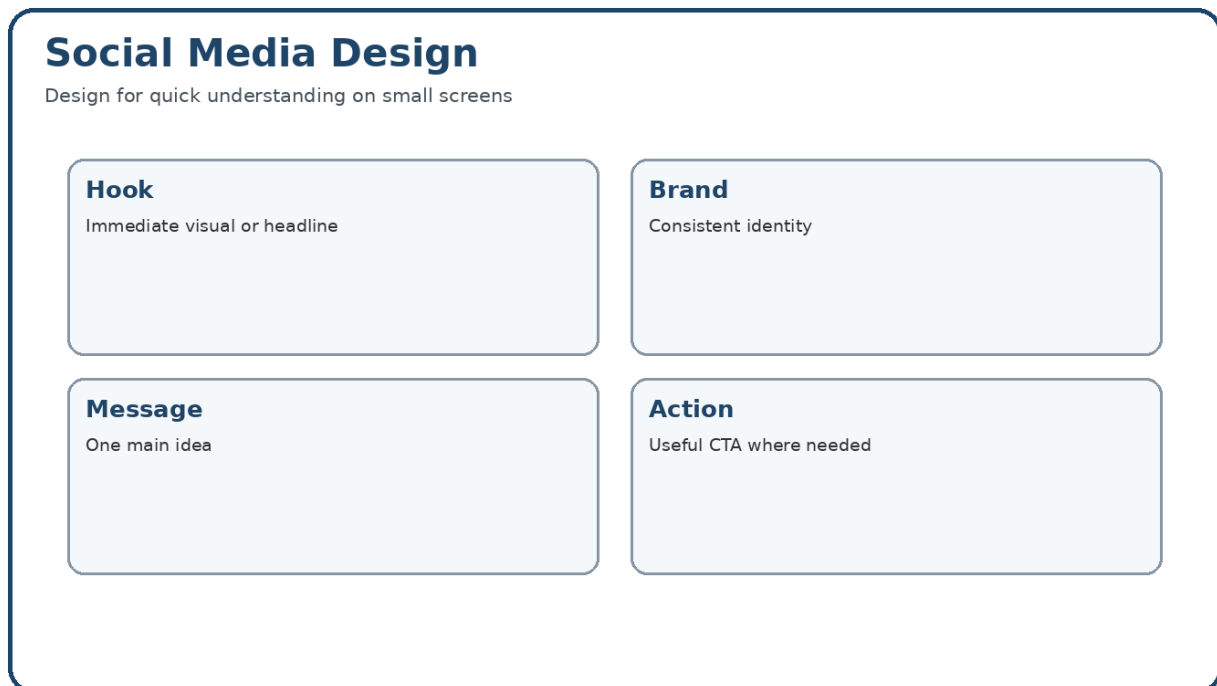


Figure 12: Original instructional visual for Designing Social Media Posts.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a square course-announcement post.
2. Use one headline, one supporting line and one CTA.
3. Add an approved logo placeholder or brand name.
4. Preview at reduced size.
5. Export a practice PNG.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Digital Academy can promote a course with a clean headline and registration action instead of placing the entire curriculum on one image.

Review Questions

64. What is the main purpose of designing social media posts?
65. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
66. What common design mistake should be avoided?
67. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 12 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 13: Designing Flyers and Posters

Introduction

Flyers and posters organise more information than a simple social post while still requiring clear hierarchy.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of designing flyers and posters.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for designing flyers and posters.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: Lead with the event, offer or announcement.

Key point: Group date, time, venue and contact details.

Key point: Use images only when they strengthen the message.

Key point: Keep essential details readable at the final size.

Key point: For print, consider margins, bleed and printer requirements where applicable.

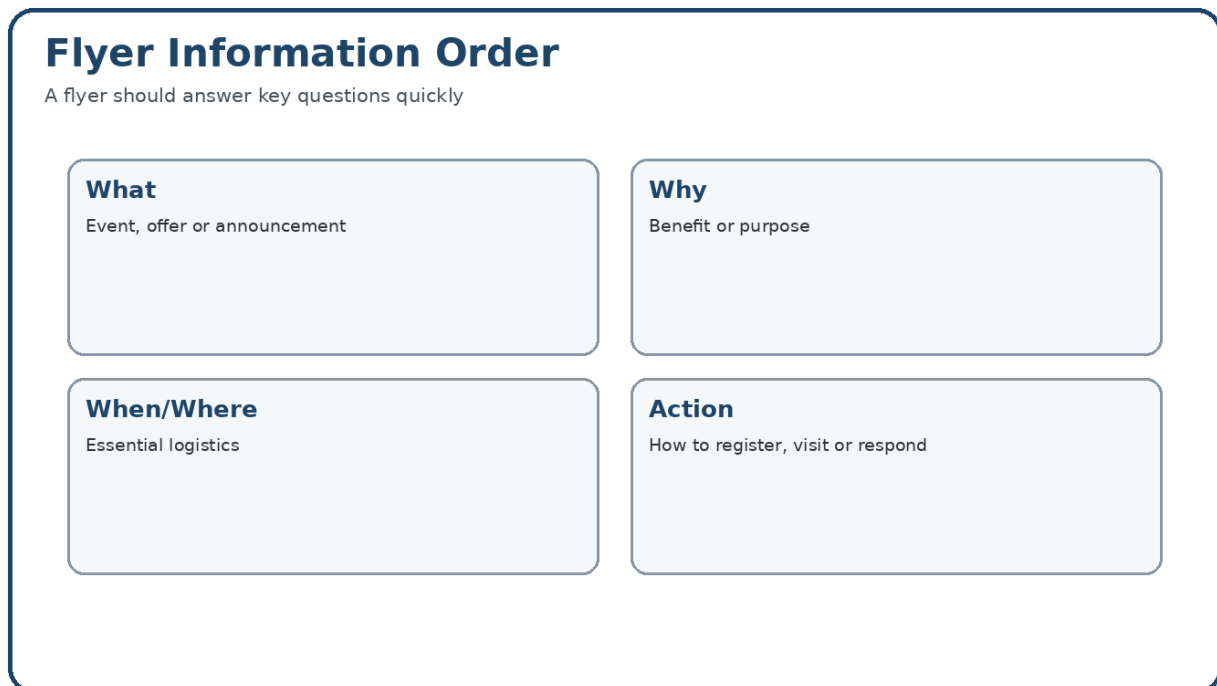


Figure 13: Original instructional visual for Designing Flyers and Posters.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create an A4 or poster-format practice design.
2. Add event name, benefit, date, venue and CTA.
3. Group logistics into one section.
4. Check alignment and spacing.
5. Export a PDF or PNG appropriate to the exercise.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

An Academy open-day flyer should make the event and next action understandable within a few seconds.

Review Questions

68. What is the main purpose of designing flyers and posters?
69. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
70. What common design mistake should be avoided?
71. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 13 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 14: Brand Identity in Canva

Introduction

Brand identity is the consistent visual expression of an organisation across materials.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of brand identity in canva.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for brand identity in canva.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: A visual identity commonly includes logo, colour palette, typography and image style.

Key point: Consistency builds recognition.

Key point: Logo clear space and legibility should be respected.

Key point: Canva brand tools may help store approved assets depending on account features.

Key point: Brand rules should work across different design sizes.

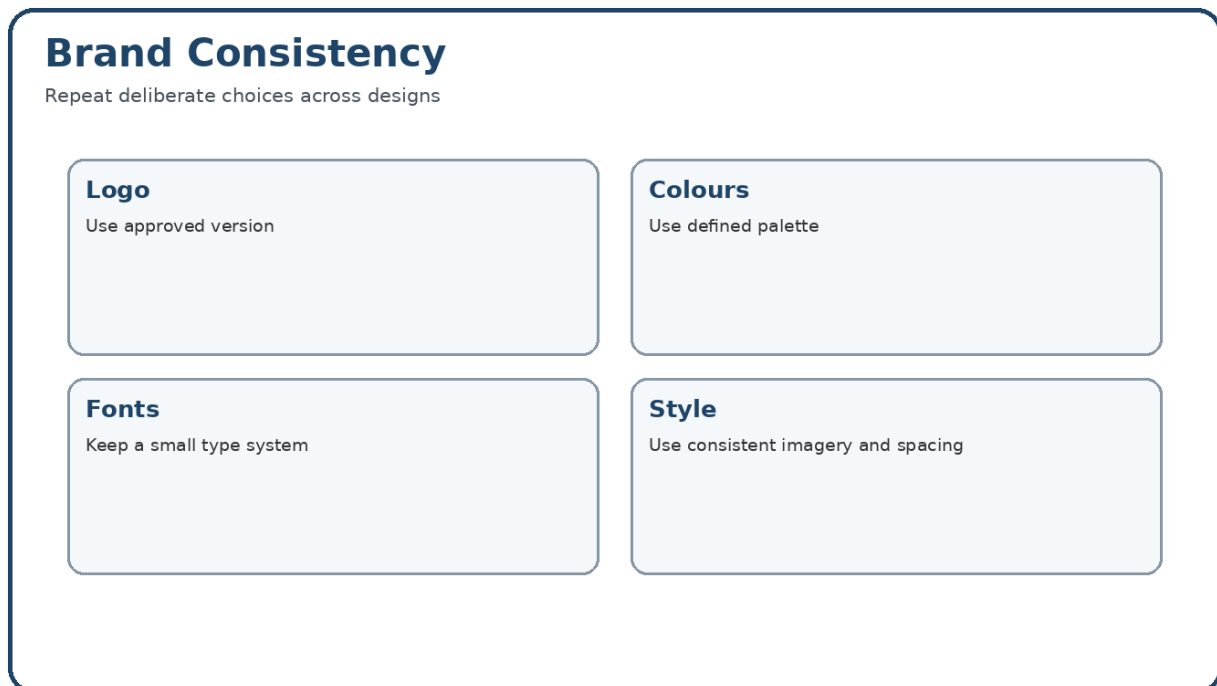


Figure 14: Original instructional visual for Brand Identity in Canva.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a one-page mini brand board.
2. Place an approved or practice logo.
3. List primary and secondary colours.
4. Show headline and body type styles.
5. Add two example image-style notes.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Digital Academy can use a brand board so multiple designers produce visually related materials.

Review Questions

72. What is the main purpose of brand identity in canva?
73. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
74. What common design mistake should be avoided?
75. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 14 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 15: Presentations and Multi-Page Designs

Introduction

Canva can create presentations, carousels and other multi-page materials with consistent structure.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of presentations and multi-page designs.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for presentations and multi-page designs.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: A presentation should have a clear beginning, development and conclusion.

Key point: Slide titles help the audience follow the structure.

Key point: Use repeated layouts carefully for consistency.

Key point: One slide should not contain an entire lecture note.

Key point: Transitions and animations should support, not distract from, the message.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a five-page mini presentation.
2. Use title, three content pages and closing page.
3. Apply one consistent type and colour system.
4. Keep each page focused on one idea.
5. Present or preview the sequence.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy instructors can create visual teaching slides that support spoken explanation rather than duplicate full manuals.

Review Questions

76. What is the main purpose of presentations and multi-page designs?
77. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
78. What common design mistake should be avoided?
79. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 15 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 16: Simple Video, Animation and Motion Design

Introduction

Canva supports simple motion content, but movement should have a communication purpose.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of simple video, animation and motion design.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for simple video, animation and motion design.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: Animation can draw attention or show sequence.

Key point: Too much movement can reduce readability.

Key point: Timing should allow viewers to read essential text.

Key point: Video and audio assets should be authorised for use.

Key point: Export format should match the publishing destination.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a three-page motion practice design.
2. Animate only one key element per page.
3. Preview timing.
4. Remove any distracting effect.
5. Export only if the account and exercise permit it.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

An Academy social announcement can use subtle motion for a headline while keeping course information easy to read.

Review Questions

80. What is the main purpose of simple video, animation and motion design?
81. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
82. What common design mistake should be avoided?
83. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 16 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 17: Exporting, File Formats and Quality

Introduction

Export choices affect quality, file size, transparency, print suitability and compatibility.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of exporting, file formats and quality.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for exporting, file formats and quality.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: PNG is useful for many sharp web graphics.

Key point: JPG can reduce file size for photographic content.

Key point: PDF is useful for documents and many print workflows.

Key point: MP4 or GIF may be used for motion content.

Key point: Always inspect the exported file before publishing.

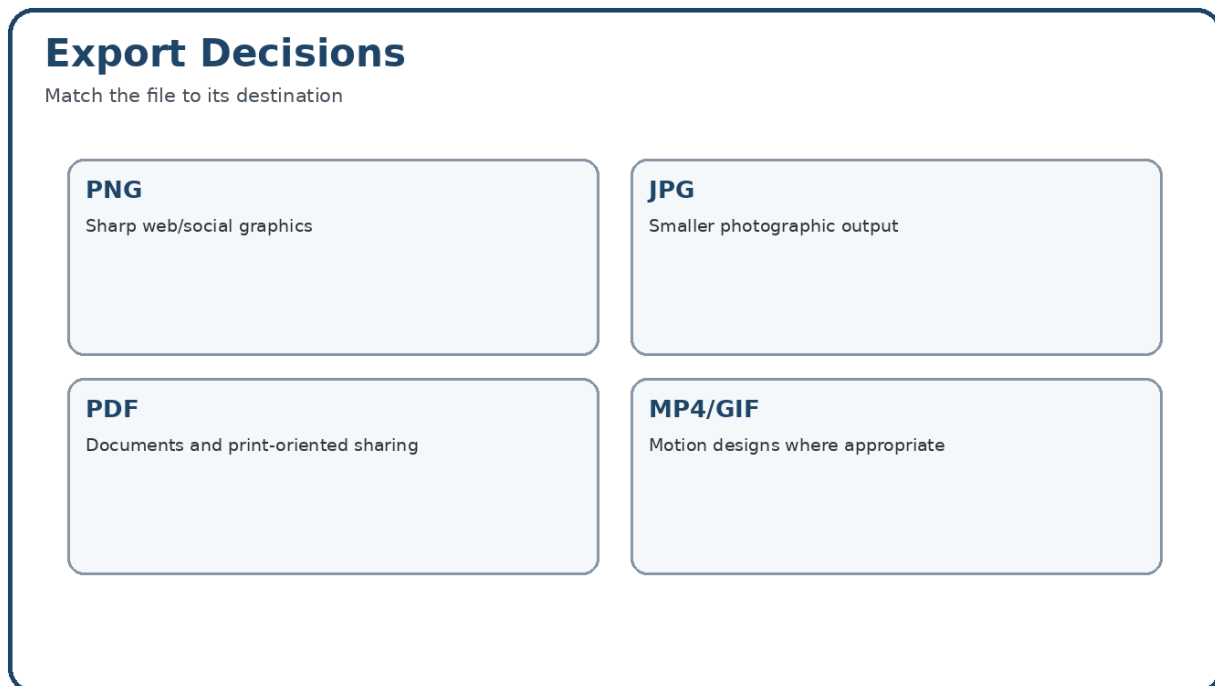


Figure 17: Original instructional visual for Exporting, File Formats and Quality.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Export one practice design as PNG.
2. Export a document-style practice design as PDF.
3. Compare file size and intended use.
4. Open the exports and check text/image quality.
5. Store exports in a clearly named folder.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Digital Academy can keep editable Canva projects separate from approved exported files.

Review Questions

84. What is the main purpose of exporting, file formats and quality?
85. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
86. What common design mistake should be avoided?
87. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 17 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 18: Design Review, Accessibility and Quality Control

Introduction

Professional design includes a final review for accuracy, readability, accessibility and consistency.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of design review, accessibility and quality control.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for design review, accessibility and quality control.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: Proofread names, dates, prices and contact details.

Key point: Check contrast and readable text size.

Key point: Avoid relying on colour alone to communicate essential meaning.

Key point: Confirm alignment, spacing and brand consistency.

Key point: Review on the device or format where the audience will see it.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Use a ten-point review checklist on a practice design.
2. Check spelling and essential details.
3. Preview on a small screen.
4. Ask a peer to identify the main message.
5. Make at least three improvements.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy graphics should be reviewed before publication so incorrect dates or unreadable text do not reach learners.

Review Questions

88. What is the main purpose of design review, accessibility and quality control?
89. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
90. What common design mistake should be avoided?
91. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 18 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Lesson 19: Final Canva Graphic Design Project

Introduction

The final project combines brief writing, hierarchy, typography, colour, imagery, brand consistency, social design, flyer design and export.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the key principles of final canva graphic design project.
- Complete a guided Canva practical for final canva graphic design project.
- Apply the lesson to an Ethan Digital Academy design scenario.

Teaching Content

Key point: Create a coordinated campaign for an approved Ethan Digital Academy training programme.

Key point: Produce a mini brand direction before designing.

Key point: Create at least three related outputs for different placements.

Key point: Use original or properly licensed content.

Key point: Document design choices and perform a final quality review.



Figure 19: Original instructional visual for Final Canva Graphic Design Project.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Write a campaign brief.
2. Create a brand board with fonts and colours.
3. Design one flyer/poster.
4. Design one square social post.
5. Design one vertical story/status graphic.
6. Export the final outputs.
7. Submit a one-page rationale explaining hierarchy, typography, colour, image and CTA choices.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

The project demonstrates the ability to turn a communication brief into a consistent small visual campaign.

Review Questions

92. What is the main purpose of final canva graphic design project?
93. State two professional design practices from this lesson.
94. What common design mistake should be avoided?
95. How would you apply this lesson to an Academy campaign?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 19 practical in Canva using original or authorised practice content. Submit the design plus a short explanation of your hierarchy, layout and visual choices.

Final Practical Project - 100 Marks

Component	Marks	Requirement
Design brief	10	Purpose, audience, message and outputs clearly defined.
Brand direction	15	Consistent palette, typography and visual style.
Flyer/poster	20	Strong hierarchy and complete essential information.
Square social post	15	Clear mobile-friendly message.
Vertical story/status	15	Adapted effectively to vertical format.
Originality/licensing	10	Responsible use of assets.
Technical export	5	Correct useful formats and file naming.
Rationale/review	10	Explains decisions and quality-control improvements.

Course Quiz - 30 Questions

1. Define graphic design.
2. What is a design brief?
3. Why must audience be identified?
4. What is visual hierarchy?
5. Name four tools for creating hierarchy.
6. What is alignment?
7. What is proximity?
8. Why is whitespace useful?
9. What is typography?
10. Why should a design use a limited font system?
11. What is colour contrast?
12. What is an accent colour?
13. Give two uses of shapes in a design.
14. Why should icons be stylistically consistent?
15. Why is image quality important?
16. What does cropping change?
17. What is stacking order?
18. Why is grouping useful?
19. What is the purpose of a template?
20. Why should templates be customised?
21. Name four parts of an effective social media graphic.
22. What essential information belongs on an event flyer?
23. What is brand identity?
24. Name four common brand identity components.
25. Why should presentation slides avoid full lecture-note paragraphs?
26. When can animation become distracting?
27. Give one suitable use for PNG.

28. Give one suitable use for PDF.
29. Name three items in a design quality review.
30. What outputs are required in the final Canva project?

Final Examination - 100 Marks

Section A - Design Foundations (20 marks)

Explain design briefs, audience, purpose, hierarchy and layout principles.

Section B - Typography, Colour and Elements (20 marks)

Explain typography systems, colour planning, shapes, icons and imagery.

Section C - Canva Production Skills (20 marks)

Explain workspace use, layers, grouping, templates and image handling.

Section D - Applied Design (20 marks)

Plan a social post, flyer and branded multi-page design for Ethan Digital Academy.

Section E - Export, Accessibility and Quality (20 marks)

Explain file formats, accessibility, proofreading, licensing and final quality control.

Course Completion Outcome

After successful completion, the learner should be able to plan and create clear, consistent Canva designs for learning, business and social communication; apply hierarchy, layout, typography, colour and image principles; customise templates responsibly; develop coordinated brand materials; export suitable files; and review work for accuracy, readability, accessibility and responsible asset use.

Professional Practice Checklist

- Start with a clear brief.
- Keep one dominant message per design.
- Use consistent fonts and colours.
- Protect readability with contrast and whitespace.
- Use original or properly licensed assets.
- Check every name, date, price and contact detail.
- Preview at the real viewing size.
- Keep editable source designs and approved exports organised.